For the first time since the assassination, an LTTE cadre was implicating another in the killing of Rajiv Gandhi and dropping the name of the militant outfit's supremo Prabhakaran. More interrogators joined in.

Koneswaran went on to divulge that Sivarasan had carried out the assassination of Padmanabha as well. Verma was watching the interrogation. The name 'Sivarasan' struck a chord—he had heard a similar name—Sivarajan—earlier. He asked Koneswaran if Sivarasan and Sivarajan were the same person. Koneswaran reluctantly confirmed it. The local police of Vedaranyam had rounded up more LTTE activists following the arrest of Koneswaran. They were all sent to Malligai. Ragothaman took Koneswaran to face them and talked about Sivarasan, aka Sivarajan. He knew that the LTTE often played with the spelling of names to confuse security agencies. Of the fresh arrivals at Malligai, one Jagdeeshan, also from Vedaranyam, identified the kurta-pyjama-clad man as 'Raghu', adding that he had travelled during the Padmanabha killing in his speedboat between Vedaranyam in Tamil Nadu and Point Pedro in Jaffna. The man had three names until then—Raghu, Sivarajan and Sivarasan.

Kanth was checking the notebook that was found on Koneswaran. Nalini, whose number was found in it, was the same girl the Q Branch had met in her office in Adyar, south Madras, and found clean. Ragothaman and Verma jumped at this revelation made by Kanth.

'They let her go? Oh no! Fake ID cards were made in their names. Also, in the name of one Sivarasan,' Verma said.

'Let me talk to the "Q Branch" about this,' Kanth said.

It certainly looked like the SIT was making good progress. During the investigation of Padmanabha's assassination, the IB had claimed that LTTE hitmen Raghu and David were behind the operation. However, the domestic spy agency had no photograph of either Raghu or David to offer. So the question of whether Raghu and David were the same person had remained unanswered. But with the arrest of Koneswaran, it was clear that Raghu alias Sivarasan alias Sivarajan was behind the killing of the EPRLF leader. Investigation later revealed that there was no 'David'. The information